

» WRESTLING NATIONAL CHAMPIONSHIPS



Coming out on top: Anshu Malik, overcoming a knee issue through rehab, secured the 59kg title by beating Worlds medallist, Sarita Mor, in an engrossing final. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

CHAOS AND CONFUSION REIGN SUPREME IN WRESTLING NATIONALS

It would be ideal for the Sports Ministry and the WFI to amicably work towards restoring **normalcy** in the wrestling administration ahead of the Paris Olympics.

Y. B. Sarangi

sarangi.y@thehindu.co.in

Following the protests by the country's top most wrestlers against the Wrestling Federation of India (WFI) for alleged sexual abuse by its then chief, Brij Bhushan Sharan Singh, and other improprieties, the National wrestling

championships returned amid utter chaos.

Held five months before the Paris Olympics, the two domestic events — one held in Pune by some Wrestling Federation of India (WFI) office-bearers and another in Jaipur by the government-sanctioned Indian Olympic Association-appointed ad hoc committee — served as an

instrument of one-upmanship in a detestable battle that hampered the wrestlers' interest.

Despite their suspension and having received warnings from the Union Sports Ministry that their event would not be recognised, the WFI, led by Sanjay Singh from Brij Bhushan's camp, proceeded to conduct the National championships.

The ad hoc body, with the full